

Introduction to Relational Event Models

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🌐: <https://github.com/martinaboschi/rem-tutorial> • •

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2026 Sunbelt Workshop — June 22, 2026



Università
della
Svizzera
italiana

Agenda



Section	Presenter	Time	Abstract
Core REMs	Melania	9:00 - 9:40	Introduction to REM formulation and inclusion of time-aware – exogenous and endogenous – variables.
REM Inference	Martina	9:45 - 10:20	Overview of likelihood-based estimation methods.
Practical 1	Melania	10:25 - 10:45	Simulating REMs and fitting model with linear effects.
Non-Linear REMs	Martina	10:50 - 11:20	Modelling non-linear and time-varying covariate effects while accounting for network and actor heterogeneity.
Practical 2	Melania	11:25 - 12:00	Analysing dynamics of species invasion using REMs beyond linear effect models

All our materials at the following link:



<https://martinaboschi.github.io/rem-tutorial/>



NOTES

Formulary, Slides, and Notes

Supporting materials for the workshops

→



WORKSHOP 1 - PRACTICAL

Introduction to Relational Event Models

Simulating and fitting REMs

→



WORKSHOP 2 - PRACTICAL

All You Need to Know About Relational Hyper-Event Modeling

Fitting and interpreting RHEMs

→



SOFTWARE

amore package

R package

→



RESOURCE

Introduction to Relational Event Modelling

Tutorial paper

→



Not sure about the notation or need a quick review?



<https://martinaboschi.github.io/rem-tutorial/>



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During our practicals...



You can either **follow along online** or **download the materials** and run them locally!

<https://martinaboschi.github.io/rem-tutorial/>



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Practical 1: Simulating Relational Events

This practical session focuses on **simulating relational events** using the `amore` package. If you would like to replicate the code locally, feel free to download the files in the box below:

Download files

- [Simulating-REM-Data.R](#) — R script
- [Simulating-REM-Data.Rmd](#) — R Markdown source

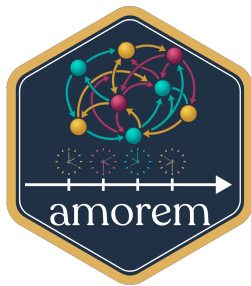
During our practicals... we will use amore package!



Newly developed R package that implements:

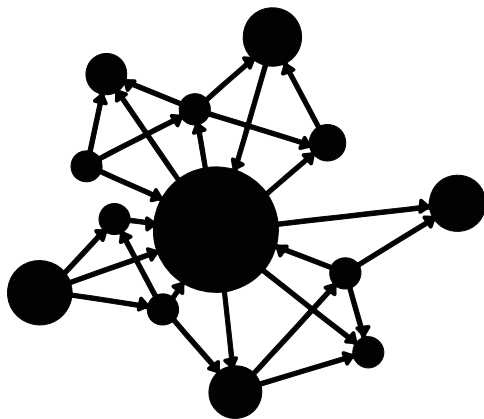
- ▶ simulation of relational event data
- ▶ flexible and computationally efficient inference techniques beyond linear effects

<https://francisorichter.github.io/amorem/>





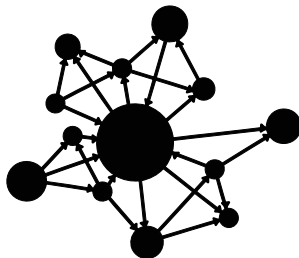
What are some phenomena you would naturally describe as a network?





What are some phenomena you would naturally describe as a network?

- ▶ email communications
- ▶ financial transactions
- ▶ non-native species invasions
- ▶ inter-hospital patient referral



Any of them *static*, for real?



What is a “longitudinal network”?

Longitudinal network: a network where edges have a temporal component:

- ▶ **relational state:** edges appear and persist in time (e.g. friendship)
- ▶ **relational event:** edges are “instantaneous” (e.g. communication)

In this workshop we will focus¹ on

relational event models

¹However relational states can be thought of as two relational events:

- ▶ **friendship start:** a relational event marking beginning of state
- ▶ **friendship end:** a relational event marking end of state



Modeling longitudinal networks

Let $\{N_{sr}(t)\}_{s \in V^S, r \in V^R, t \geq 0}$ be **longitudinal network**:

- ▶ $N_{sr}(t)$ = number of interactions from s to r until time t .
- ▶ $N_{sr}(0) = 0$

Mathematically, it is always possible to decompose:

$$N_{sr}(t) = \underbrace{\Lambda_{sr}(t)}_{\text{structural part}} + \underbrace{M_{sr}(t)}_{\text{noise part}}$$

If it exists, then the **hazard**

$$\lambda_{sr}(t) = \frac{d\Lambda_{sr}}{dt}(t)$$

is *instantaneous rate* that (s, r) occurs at time t .



What is a hazard?

Hazard (also: rate, intensity): “instantaneous probability” that event occurs now.

Mathematically:

$$P((s, r) \text{ occurs } (t, t + \delta t] \mid \text{did not occur until } t) \approx \lambda_{sr}(t)\delta t$$

So, if we know **hazard**:

- ▶ we know **entire probabilistic structure** of event network
- ▶ we can **simulate** relational events:
 - **Gillespie algorithm**: using exponential event times $\text{Exp}(\lambda_{sr})$.
 - **tau-leap algorithm**: using small time increments δt

Modeling hazard = modelling network



Let

$$\lambda_{sr}(t) = \underbrace{W_{sr}(t)}_{\text{Is } (s, r) \text{ at risk?}} \times \underbrace{\lambda_0(t)}_{\text{baseline hazard}} \times \underbrace{\exp\{f(x_{sr}(t), t)\}}_{\text{edge-specific risk factors}}$$

where

- ▶ $W_{sr}(t)$: edge-specific risk indicator
e.g. a past paper *cannot* cite a future paper.
- ▶ $\lambda_0(t)$: global risk determinants
e.g. very few emails sent when it's night at time t .
- ▶ $f(x_{sr}(t), t)$: edge-specific risk determinants
e.g. if r is a popular person, then (s, r) more likely.



How does a relational event network unfold?

Let's consider 5 individuals applying for a job:

- ▶ Each has “work experience”-score WE given by

0, 3, 5, 9, 11 years

- ▶ They need to get **two references letters** from each other.
- ▶ Person s contacts person r for a reference letter with rate,

$$\lambda_{sr}(t) = W_{sr}(t)e^{-1.5|WE_s - WE_r|}.$$

- ▶ Value -1.5 identifies
 - **relevance of WE:** it is not zero
 - **direction of WE:** larger WE difference $\Rightarrow$ fewer requests
- ▶ W_{sr} has value
 - 1 until person s has reached out to 2 people,
 - after which it returns to 0.



Distribution of event times



There are $5 \times 4 = 20$ requests “waiting” to be asked. Let

ΔT_{sr} = waiting time until s asks r for a letter

The distribution of ΔT_{sr} is given as

$$\Delta T_{sr} \sim \text{Exp}(e^{-1.5|W E_s - W E_r|})$$



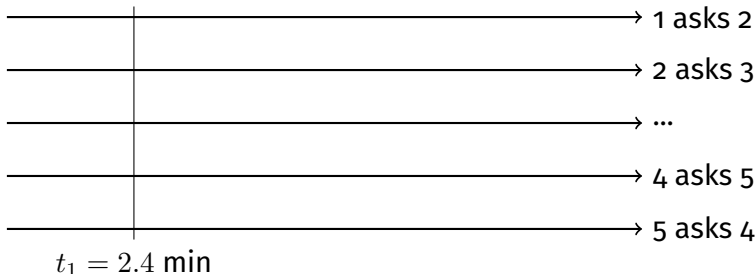
When will first request be sent out?

The first request will happen at time T_1 , where

$$T_1 = \min_{sr} \Delta T_{sr}$$

Using property that **minimum of exponentials is exponential**,

$$T_1 \sim \text{Exp} \left(\sum_{s,r} e^{-1.5|WE_s - WE_r|} \approx 0.23 \right)$$





Which pair of individuals make up first request?

We now know that first event happened at t_1 . But which one?

E_1 = event that happened at time t_1 .

Using property that **which exponential is minimum is multinomial**,

$$E_1 \sim \text{Multinomial} \left(\frac{e^{-1.5|WE_1 - WE_2|}}{\sum_{s,r} e^{-1.5|WE_s - WE_r|}}, \dots, \frac{e^{-1.5|WE_5 - WE_4|}}{\sum_{s,r} e^{-1.5|WE_s - WE_r|}} \right)$$





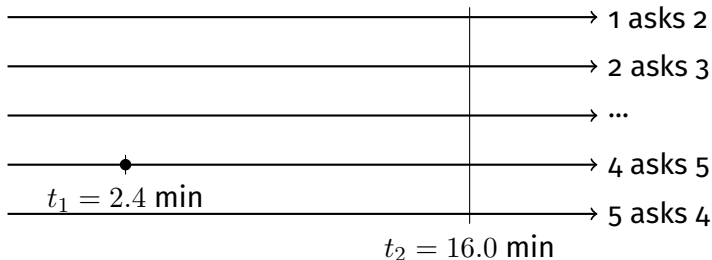
When will second request be sent out?

The second request will happen at time T_2 , where

$$T_2 = \min_{sr \neq s_1 r_1} \Delta T_{sr}$$

Using [memoryless property of an exponential](#),

$$T_2 \sim T_1 + \text{Exp} \left(\sum_{(s,r) \neq (s_1, r_1)} e^{-1.5|WE_s - WE_r|} \approx 0.18 \right)$$





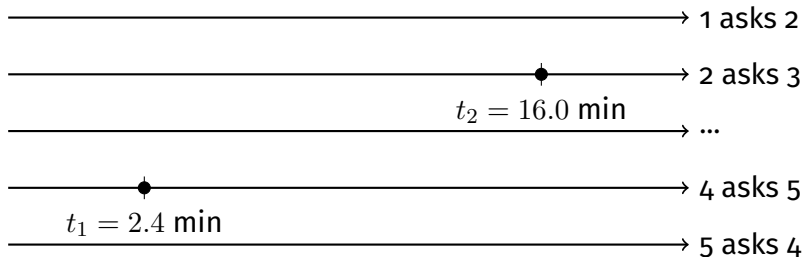
Which pair of individuals make up second request?

We know second event happened at $t_2 = 16.0$ min. Which one?

E_2 = event that happened at time t_2 .

Using property that **which exponential is minimum is multinomial**,

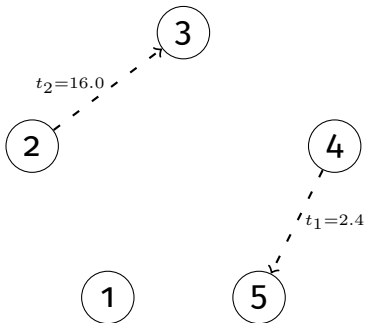
$$E_2 \sim \text{Multinomial} \left(\frac{e^{-1.5|WE_1 - WE_2|}}{0.18}, \dots, \frac{e^{-1.5|WE_5 - WE_4|}}{0.18} \right)$$



Repeat... to obtain a dynamic network



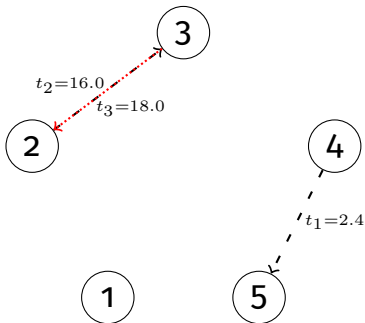
Repeating above procedure another 8 times, results in:



Repeat... to obtain a dynamic network



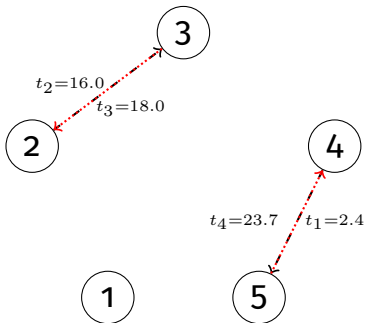
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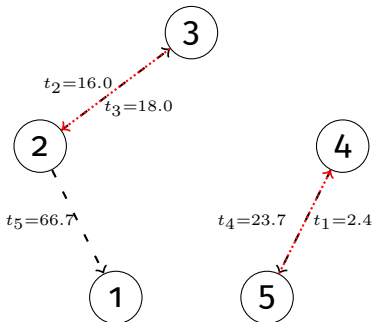
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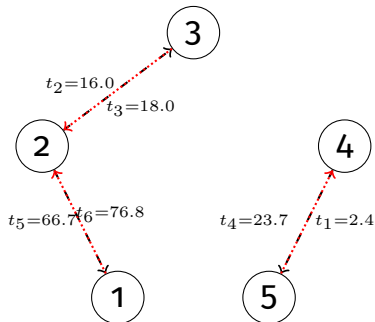
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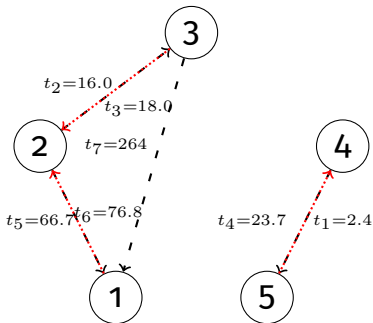
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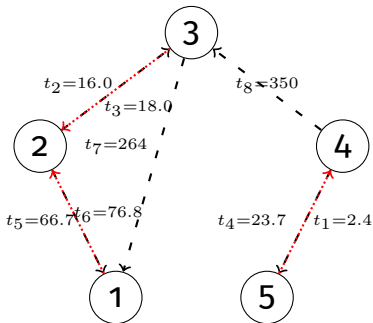
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Repeat... to obtain a dynamic network



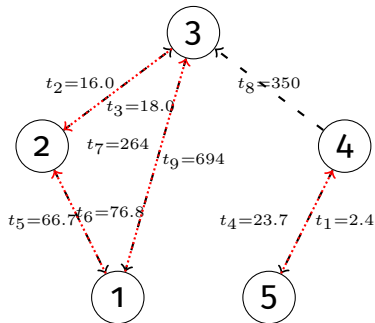
Repeating above procedure another 8 times, results in:



Repeat... to obtain a dynamic network



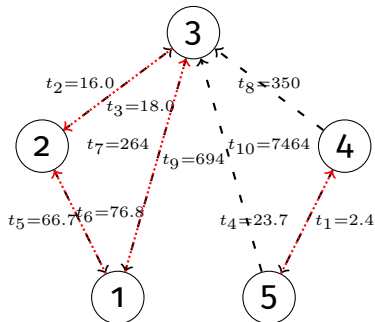
Repeating above procedure another 8 times, results in:





Repeat... to obtain a dynamic network

Repeating above procedure another 8 times, results in:





From Data to Answers

Let's assume that someone gave us this dynamic network:

	time	solicitor	receiver	WE_s	WE_r	$WE_{abs-diff}$
1	2.4	4	5	9	11	2
2	16.0	2	3	3	5	2
3	18.0	3	2	5	3	2
4	23.7	5	4	11	9	2
5	66.7	2	1	3	0	3
6	76.8	1	2	0	3	3
7	264.4	3	1	5	0	5
8	349.8	4	3	9	5	4
9	694.1	1	3	0	5	5
10	7463.6	5	3	11	5	6

Could we determine influence of WE on this dynamic? Yes, by doing **inference**!



Inference on what?

$$\lambda_{sr}(t) = \underbrace{W_{sr}(t)}_{\text{Is } (s,r) \text{ at risk?}} \times \underbrace{\lambda_0(t)}_{\text{baseline hazard}} \times \underbrace{\exp\{f(x_{sr}(t), t)\}}_{\text{edge-specific risk factors}}$$

We now focus on what the $x_{sr}(t)$ can be...

Also called:

- ▶ event statistics
- ▶ explanatory variables
- ▶ covariates
- ▶ risk factors
- ▶ drivers



Exogenous VS Endogenous drivers

Back to the example...

Work experience similarity $x_{sr}(t) = |WE_s - WE_r|$ depends on:

- ▶ Work experience score WE_s which is a node-level attribute, that does not depend on prior interactions → **exogenous** covariate
- ▶ Work experience similarity between s and r is dyadic, still exogenous.



Exogenous VS Endogenous drivers

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- ▶ Work experience score WE_s which is a node-level attribute, that does not depend on prior interactions → **exogenous** covariate
- ▶ Work experience similarity between s and r is dyadic, still exogenous.
- ▶ Age, gender, occupation, time-zone, distance and any function of them...

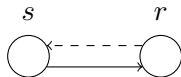
Exogenous VS Endogenous drivers



But prior events influence future events...

In the reference letters example: *I ask you, you ask me.*

$\rightsquigarrow$ Reciprocity (*binary*) $x_{sr}(t) = \mathbf{1}(\{(r, s, t^*) \mid t^* < t\} \neq \emptyset)$



	time	solicitor	receiver	WE _{abs-diff}	REC _{binary}
1	2.4	4	5	2	0
2	16.0	2	3	2	0
3	18.0	3	2	2	1
4	23.7	5	4	2	1
5	66.7	2	1	3	0
6	76.8	1	2	3	1
7	264.4	3	1	5	0
8	349.8	4	3	4	0
9	694.1	1	3	5	1
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Exogenous VS Endogenous drivers



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Depends on prior interactions $\rightarrow$ **endogenous** covariate

Exogenous VS Endogenous drivers



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Depends on prior interactions $\rightarrow$ **endogenous** covariate

Alternative choice for reciprocity definition:

- ▶ $x_{sr}(t) = \text{number of occurrences of } (r, s) \text{ before } t$
- ▶ $z_{sr}(t) = \begin{cases} t - \tau_{sr}, & \tau_{sr} = \text{time of last event } (r, s) \\ \infty, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} \rightarrow \text{defined as **internal time**}$
- we transform to $x_{sr}(t) = \exp(-z_{sr}(t)) \rightsquigarrow$ the closer to zero the further in time, closer to one the opposite.

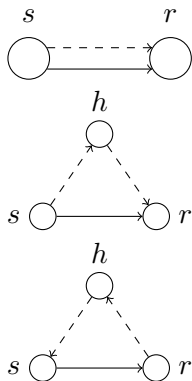
Exogenous VS Endogenous drivers



But prior events influence future events...

Similar kind of definitions can be used for various endogenous mechanisms:

- ▶ Repetition (*I ask you, I ask you again*)
- ▶ Triadic closure (*I ask you, you ask them, so I ask them*)
- ▶ Cyclic closure (*They ask you, you ask me, so I ask them*)
- ▶ ...

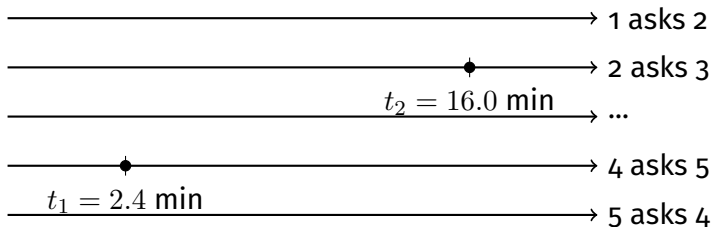




Versatility isn't cheap...

Endogenous variables powerful for dependence between edges but computationally intensive to compute:

- ▶ n relational events and $|V^S| = |V^R| = p \rightsquigarrow p^2$ possible interactions
- ▶ for each edge, look at all previous events and check which satisfy the condition of interest... on average $\frac{n}{2}$
- ▶ $\implies$ Complexity is $O(n^2 p^2)$ in the worst case, just for dyadic...





Inference of what?

$$\lambda_{sr}(t) = W_{sr}(t) \times \lambda_0(t) \times \exp\{f(x_{sr}(t), t)\}$$

Consider $f(x_{sr}(t), t) = \beta \cdot x_{sr}(t)$:

- ▶ Work experience similarity $x_{sr}(t) = |WE_s - WE_r| \rightsquigarrow \beta < 0$ the greater the difference in work experience, the less likely it is to ask for reference letter
- ▶ Reciprocity $x_{sr}(t) = \exp(-(t - \tau_{sr})) \rightsquigarrow \beta > 0$ the more recent the email, the more likely it's replied to soon (in principle...)

Estimating effect β given data = inference

Descending into Dante's Inferno...



Abandon hope all ye who enter here...

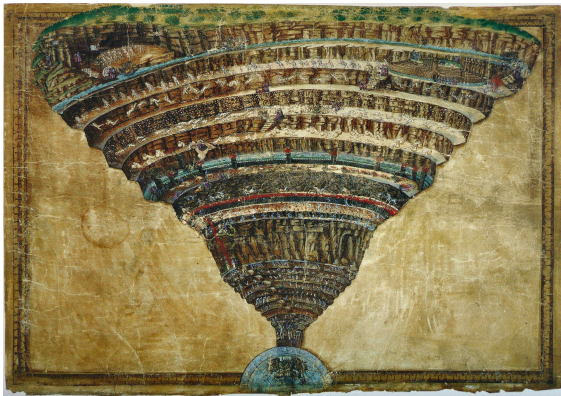
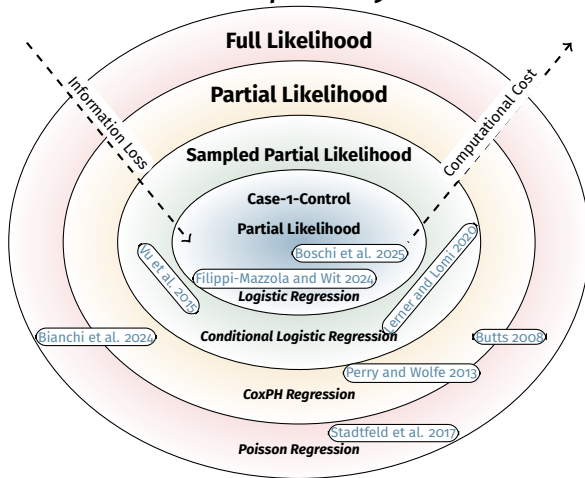


Fig. 1: Watts, Barbara J.: “Sandro Botticelli’s Drawings for Dante’s Inferno”



...or through rings of Likelihood?

Maintain Abandon hope all ye who enter here...



A quick recap!



Relational Data: stream of observed events.

$$E = \{(s_i, r_i, t_i), i = 1, \dots, n\}$$

Parametric Model: linear (in log-hazard)... just for now!

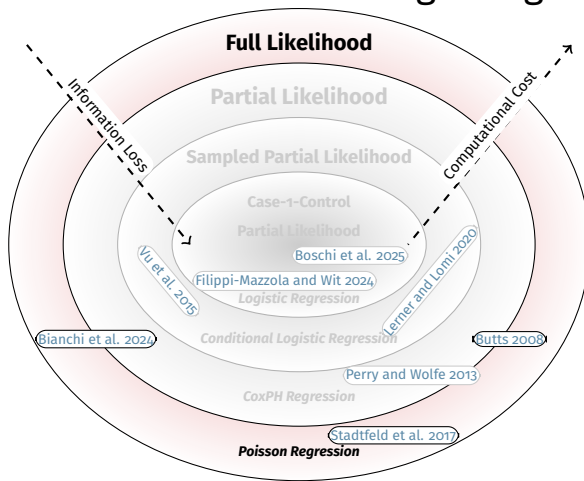
$$\lambda_{sr}(t) = W_{sr}(t) \times \lambda_0(t) \times \exp \{\beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{sr}(t)\}$$

Likelihood: constructed as joint probability of observing **data** under **model**.

AIM: estimate β that maximizes **likelihood**.



Let's start from the beginning...





Full Likelihood: Let's follow the definition...

Likelihood: constructed as joint probability of observing **data** under **model**.

$$\begin{aligned}
 \mathcal{L}(\beta) &= p(E; \beta) \quad \begin{array}{c} \text{Perry and Wolfe [2013]} \\ \underbrace{\hspace{1cm}} \\ \text{Multiplication Theorem} \end{array} \\
 &= \prod_{i=1}^n \left[p\left(t_i \mid \underbrace{t_1, (s_1, r_1), \dots, t_{i-1}, (s_{i-1}, r_{i-1})}_{\text{previous events}}; \beta\right) \times \right. \\
 &\quad \left. p\left((s_i, r_i) \mid t_i, \underbrace{t_1, (s_1, r_1), \dots, t_{i-1}, (s_{i-1}, r_{i-1})}_{\text{previous events}}; \beta\right) \right] \\
 &\quad \text{events are independent **conditional on history**} \\
 &\quad \text{along with covariates, incorporated by } \mathbb{W} = \{\mathcal{W}_t\}_{t \in \mathbb{R}^+} \\
 &= \prod_{i=1}^n p(t_i | \mathcal{W}_{t_i^-}; \beta) p((s_i, r_i) | t_i, \mathcal{W}_{t_i^-}; \beta)
 \end{aligned}$$



$$\mathcal{L}(\beta) = \prod_{i=1}^n p(t_i | \mathcal{W}_{t_i^-}) \times p((s_i, r_i) | t_i, \mathcal{W}_{t_i^-}; \beta)$$

How to account for fact that there are not other dyads observed in (t_{i-1}, t_i) ?

$$\underbrace{\prod_{i=1}^n \sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta) \exp \left[- \sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \int_{t_{i-1}}^{t_i} \lambda_{sr}(u; \beta) du \right]}_{\text{Minimum Generalized Exponential Inter-arrival Time}} \times \underbrace{p((s_i, r_i) | t_i, \mathcal{W}_{t_i^-}; \beta)}_{\text{Multinomial Probability}} = \frac{\lambda_{s_i r_i}(t_i; \beta)}{\sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta)}$$

Full Likelihood for... Piecewise Constant Rates (PCR) I



$$\mathcal{L}(\beta) = \underbrace{\prod_{i=1}^n \sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta) \exp \left[- \sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \int_{t_{i-1}}^{t_i} \lambda_{sr}(u; \beta) du \right]}_{\text{Minimum Generalized Exponential Inter-arrival Time}} \times \underbrace{\frac{p((s_i, r_i) | t_i, \mathcal{W}_{t_i}^-; \beta)}{\sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta)}}_{\text{Multinomial Probability}}$$

What if **hazard is assumed to be constant within inter-arrival times?**

$$\underbrace{\prod_{i=1}^n \sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta) \times \exp \left[- \sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta) (t_i - t_{i-1}) \right]}_{\text{Exponential waiting time } \Delta T_i = T_i - T_{i-1} \text{ - Poisson N. of Events in } \Delta T_i} \times \frac{\lambda_{s_i r_i}(t_i; \beta)}{\sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta)}$$

Full Likelihood for... Piecewise Constant Rates (PCR) II



$$\begin{aligned}
 \mathcal{L}(\beta) &\stackrel{\text{PCR}}{=} \prod_{i=1}^n \sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta) \times \exp \left[- \sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta) (t_i - t_{i-1}) \right] \frac{\lambda_{s_i r_i}(t_i; \beta)}{\sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta)} \\
 &\quad \prod_{i=1}^n \lambda_{s_i r_i}(t_i; \beta) \prod_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \exp [-\lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta) (t_i - t_{i-1})]
 \end{aligned}$$

Full Likelihood for... Piecewise Constant Rates (PCR) III



$$\begin{aligned}
 \mathcal{L}(\beta) &\stackrel{\text{PCR}}{=} \prod_{i=1}^n \sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta) \times \exp \left[- \sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta) (t_i - t_{i-1}) \right] \frac{\lambda_{s_i r_i}(t_i; \beta)}{\sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta)} \\
 &\quad \prod_{i=1}^n \lambda_{s_i r_i}(t_i; \beta) \prod_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \exp [-\lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta) (t_i - t_{i-1})] \\
 &\quad \text{Call } \Delta N_{sr}(t_i) = N_{sr}(t_i) - N_{sr}(t_{i-1}) \\
 &\quad \prod_{i=1}^n \prod_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} (\lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta))^{\Delta N_{sr}(t_i)} \exp [-\lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta) (t_i - t_{i-1})] \\
 &\quad \underbrace{\hspace{15em}}_{\text{Proportional to likelihood of a \textbf{Poisson Regression}}}
 \end{aligned}$$

So, which statistical model should we focus on? (Pt. 1)



Full Log-Likelihood (Piecewise Constant Rates):

$$\ell(\beta) = \sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \Delta N_{sr}(t_i) \log(\lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta)) - \lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta)(t_i - t_{i-1})$$

Modeling:

Relational Event Model

$$\lambda_{sr}(t) = W_{sr}(t) \times \lambda_0(t) \times \exp\{\beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{sr}(t)\}$$

Inference:

Poisson Regression

$$\Delta N_{sr}(t_i) | \mathbf{x}_{sr}(t_i) \stackrel{\text{iid}}{\sim} \text{Poisson}(\mu_{sr}(t_i))$$

$$\log(\mu_{sr}(t_i)) = \beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{sr}(t_i) + \log(t_i - t_{i-1})$$

So, which statistical model should we focus on? (Pt. 1)



Full Log-Likelihood (Piecewise Constant Rates):

$$\ell(\beta) = \sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \Delta N_{sr}(t_i) \log(\lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta)) - \lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta)(t_i - t_{i-1})$$

Modeling:

Relational Event Model

$$\lambda_{sr}(t) = W_{sr}(t) \times \lambda_0(t) \times \exp\{\beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{sr}(t)\}$$

Inference:

Poisson Regression

$$\Delta N_{sr}(t_i) | \mathbf{x}_{sr}(t_i) \stackrel{\text{iid}}{\sim} \text{Poisson}(\mu_{sr}(t_i))$$

$$\log(\mu_{sr}(t_i)) = \beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{sr}(t_i) + \log(t_i - t_{i-1})$$

Nice... But at what **price**?

1. Strong Assumption;
2. High Computational Cost;



Full Likelihood in Practice I

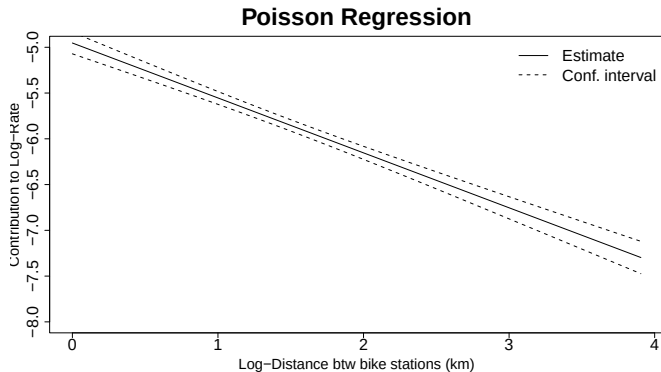
Full Log-Likelihood (Piecewise Constant Rates):

$$\ell(\beta) = \sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \Delta N_{sr}(t_i) \log(\lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta)) - \lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta)(t_i - t_{i-1})$$

stratum	event	sender	receiver	time	dist	logtm
1	1	31419	31255	0.0218023	1.6832458	0.0218023
1	0	31261	31071	0.0218023	1.8376884	0.0218023
1	0	31937	32050	0.0218023	2.7475273	0.0218023
1	0	31937	31937	0.0218023	0.0000000	0.0218023
1	0	31071	31023	0.0218023	1.9742199	0.0218023
1	0	31937	31272	0.0218023	2.0297259	0.0218023
1	0	32217	31255	0.0218023	3.8173386	0.0218023
1	0	32604	31966	0.0218023	2.4291296	0.0218023
1	0	32050	31937	0.0218023	2.7357951	0.0218023
1	0	31285	31324	0.0218023	0.5883421	0.0218023



```
glm(event ~ dist + offset(logtm),
family = poisson(link = "log"), data = poisson_dat)
```





Full Likelihood via Poisson Regression... At what price?

1. Strong Assumption;
2. High Computational Cost;

Can we do better?



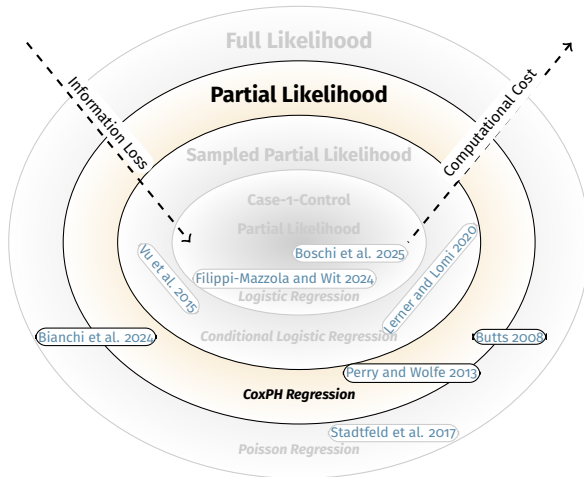
Full Likelihood via Poisson Regression... At what price?

1. Strong Assumption;
2. High Computational Cost;

Can we do better? Let's do one step back:

$$\mathcal{L}(\beta) = \prod_{i=1}^n \sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta) \exp \left[- \sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \int_{t_{i-1}}^{t_i} \lambda_{sr}(u; \beta) \mathrm{d}u \right] \times \frac{\lambda_{s_i r_i}(t_i; \beta)}{\sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \lambda_{sr}(t_i; \beta)}$$

Partial Likelihood Inference





Inspired by Cox [1975]: REM's Partial Likelihood I

Partial likelihood focuses on **multinomial probability of observing a specific dyad among those at risk, given that an event has occurred**.

$$\mathcal{L}^P(\beta) = \prod_{i=1}^n \frac{\lambda_{s_i r_i}(t_i | \mathcal{W}_{t_i}^-; \beta)}{\sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \lambda_{sr}(t_i | \mathcal{W}_{t_i}^-; \beta)} = \prod_{i=1}^n \frac{\exp \{ \beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{s_i r_i}(t_i) \}}{\sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \exp \{ \beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{sr}(t_i) \}}$$



Inspired by Cox [1975]: REM's Partial Likelihood II

Partial likelihood focuses on **multinomial probability of observing a specific dyad among those at risk, given that an event has occurred**.

$$\mathcal{L}^P(\beta) = \prod_{i=1}^n \frac{\lambda_{s_i r_i}(t_i | \mathcal{W}_{t_i}^-; \beta)}{\sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \lambda_{sr}(t_i | \mathcal{W}_{t_i}^-; \beta)} = \prod_{i=1}^n \frac{\exp \{ \beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{s_i r_i}(t_i) \}}{\sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \exp \{ \beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{sr}(t_i) \}}$$

Information Loss:

Leaving $\lambda_0(t)$ arbitrary
results in
slight loss of information
about β .

Dimensionality reduction:

effective when providing a
simplification
of full likelihood by
eliminating
nuisance parameters.

Event Ordering:

Applicable when
only order of
events is known,
not their exact timing.

So, which statistical model should we focus on? (Pt. 2)



Partial Log-likelihood:

$$\ell^P(\beta) = \log \mathcal{L}^P(\beta) = \sum_{i=1}^n \left[\beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{s_i r_i}(t_i) - \log \left(\sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \exp \{ \beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{sr}(t_i) \} \right) \right],$$

Modeling:

Relational Event Model

$$\lambda_{sr}(t) = W_{sr}(t) \times \lambda_0(t) \times \exp \{ \beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{sr}(t) \}$$

Inference:

CoxPH Regression

$$\hat{\beta} = \arg \max_{\beta} \ell^P(\beta)$$



Partial Likelihood in Practice I

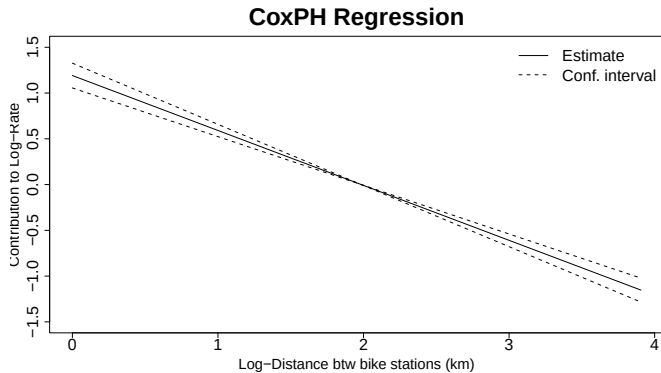
Partial Log-Likelihood:

$$\ell^P(\beta) = \log \mathcal{L}^P(\beta) = \sum_{i=1}^n \left[\beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{s_i r_i}(t_i) - \log \left(\sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \exp \{ \beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{sr}(t_i) \} \right) \right],$$

stratum	event	sender	receiver	time	dist
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1	0	31261	31071	0.0218023	1.8376884
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1	0	32604	31966	0.0218023	2.4291296
1	0	32050	31937	0.0218023	2.7357951
1	0	31285	31324	0.0218023	0.5883421



```
rem(event ~ dist, data = cox_dat, method = "clogit", stratum = "stratum")
```





Full Likelihood via Poisson Regression... At what price?

1. Strong Assumption;
2. High Computational Cost;

Can we do better?



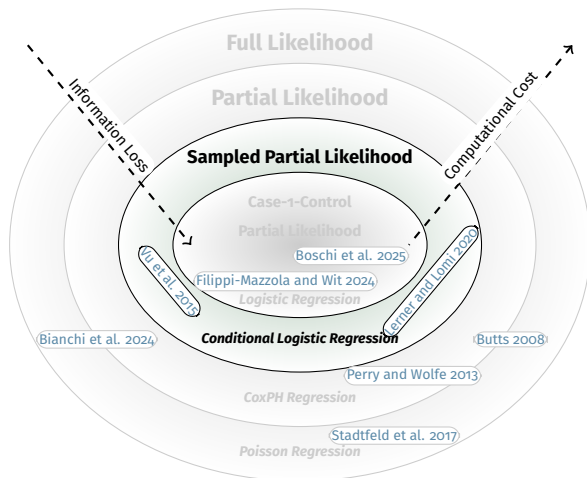
Full Likelihood via Poisson Regression... At what price?

1. Strong Assumption;
2. High Computational Cost;

Can we do better? Let's do one step back:

$$\mathcal{L}^P(\beta) = \prod_{i=1}^n \frac{\lambda_{s_i r_i}(t_i; \mathcal{W}_{t_i^-}; \beta)}{\sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \lambda_{sr}(t_i; \mathcal{W}_{t_i^-}; \beta)} = \prod_{i=1}^n \frac{\exp \{ \beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{s_i r_i}(t_i) \}}{\sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{R}_{t_i}} \exp \{ \beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{sr}(t_i) \}}$$

Sampled Partial Likelihood Inference





What changes when we sample? I

Relational Data: stream of observed events and sampled risk sets.

$$D_m = \{(s_i, r_i, t_i, \mathcal{SR}_{t_i}), |\mathcal{SR}_{t_i}| = m + 1, i = 1, \dots, n\},$$

where $\mathcal{SR}_{t_i} \subset \mathcal{R}_{t_i}$ is **sampled risk set** at time t_i .



What changes when we sample? I

Relational Data: stream of observed events and sampled risk sets.

$$D_m = \{(s_i, r_i, t_i, \mathcal{SR}_{t_i}), |\mathcal{SR}_{t_i}| = m + 1, i = 1, \dots, n\},$$

where $\mathcal{SR}_{t_i} \subset \mathcal{R}_{t_i}$ is **sampled risk set** at time t_i .

Updated Filtration: incorporating history of events and sampling information.

$$\{\mathcal{F}_t\}_{t \geq 0}, \quad \mathcal{F}_t = \mathcal{W}_t \cup \sigma(\mathcal{SR}_{t_i}; t_i \leq t)$$



What changes when we sample? I

Relational Data: stream of observed events and sampled risk sets.

$$D_m = \{(s_i, r_i, t_i, \mathcal{SR}_{t_i}), |\mathcal{SR}_{t_i}| = m + 1, i = 1, \dots, n\},$$

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Updated Filtration: incorporating history of events and sampling information.

$$\{\mathcal{F}_t\}_{t \geq 0}, \quad \mathcal{F}_t = \mathcal{W}_t \cup \sigma(\mathcal{SR}_{t_i}; t_i \leq t)$$

Parametric Model: let's stay linear for the moment...

$$\lambda_{sr, \mathcal{SR}}(t) = \lambda_{sr}(t) \cdot \pi_t(\mathcal{SR} | (s, r)), \quad \pi_t(\mathcal{SR} | (s, r)) = \frac{m}{|\mathcal{R}_t| - 1} \cdot 1_{\{(s, r) \in \mathcal{SR}, \mathcal{SR} \subset \mathcal{R}_t\}}$$

m is the **number of sampled non-events** according to **nested case-control sampling**.



What changes when we sample? II

Sampled Partial likelihood:

$$\mathcal{L}^S(\beta) = \prod_{i=1}^n \frac{\lambda_{s_i r_i}(t_i; \mathcal{F}_{t_i}^-; \beta) \cdot \pi_{t_i}(\mathcal{SR}_{t_i} | (s_i, r_i))}{\sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{SR}_{t_i}} \lambda_{sr}(t_i; \mathcal{F}_{t_i}^-; \beta) \cdot \pi_{t_i}(\mathcal{SR}_{t_i} | (s, r))} = \prod_{i=1}^n \frac{\exp\{\beta \cdot x_{s_i r_i}(t_i)\}}{\sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{SR}_{t_i}} \exp\{\beta \cdot x_{sr}(t_i)\}}$$

Look Familiar?

Conditional logistic regression

🌐 1 language ▾

Article Talk

Read Edit View history Tools ▾

From Wikipedia, the free encyclopedia

Conditional logistic regression is an extension of [logistic regression](#) that allows one to account for [stratification](#) and [matching](#). Its main field of application is [observational studies](#) and in particular [epidemiology](#). It was devised in 1978 by [Norman Breslow](#), [Nicholas Day](#), [Katherine Halvorsen](#), [Ross L. Prentice](#) and [C. Sabat](#).^[1] It is the most flexible and general procedure for matched data.

Background [edit]

Observational studies use [stratification](#) or [matching](#) as a way to control for [confounding](#).

[Logistic regression](#) can account for stratification by having a different constant term for each stratum. Let us denote $Y_{it} \in \{0, 1\}$ the label (e.g. case status) of the t th observation of the i th stratum and $X_{it} \in \mathbb{R}^p$ the values of the corresponding predictors. We then take the likelihood of one observation to be

$$P(Y_{it} = 1 | X_{it}) = \frac{\exp(\alpha_i + \beta^\top X_{it})}{1 + \exp(\alpha_i + \beta^\top X_{it})}$$

Fig. 2: Source: Wikipedia

Stratification...
with respect to what?
By case!

So, which statistical model should we focus on? (Pt. 3)



Sampled Partial likelihood:

$$\mathcal{L}^S(\beta) = \prod_{i=1}^n \frac{\exp \{\beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{s_i r_i}(t_i)\}}{\sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{SR}_{t_i}} \exp \{\beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{sr}(t_i)\}}$$

Modeling:

Relational Event Model

$$\lambda_{sr}(t) = W_{sr}(t) \times \lambda_0(t) \times \exp \{\beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{sr}(t)\}$$

Inference:

Conditional Logistic Regression

$$\Delta N_{sr}(t_i) | \sum_{s',r' \in \mathcal{SR}_{t_i}} \Delta N_{s'r'}(t_i) = 1 \sim \text{Categorical}(\pi_{sr}(t_i))$$

$$\pi_{sr}(t_i) = \frac{\exp \{\beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{sr}(t_i)\}}{\sum_{(s',r') \in \mathcal{SR}_{t_i}} \exp \{\beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{s'r'}(t_i)\}}$$



Sampled Partial Likelihood in Practice I

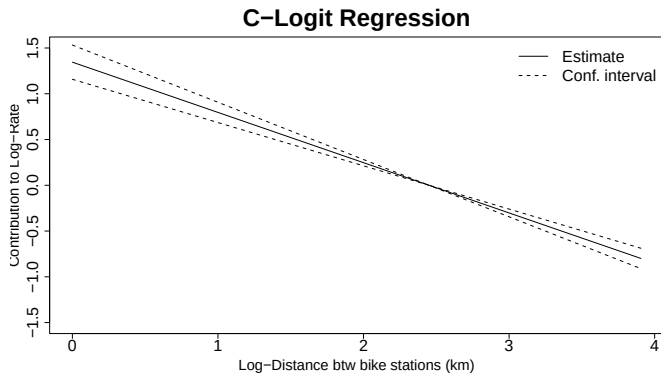
Sampled Partial Log-Likelihood:

$$\ell^S(\beta) = \log \mathcal{L}^S(\beta) = \sum_{i=1}^n \left[\beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{s_i r_i}(t_i) - \log \left(\sum_{(s,r) \in \mathcal{SR}_{t_i}} \exp \{ \beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{sr}(t_i) \} \right) \right],$$

stratum	event	sender	receiver	time	dist
1	1	31023	31261	0.0102023	2.042388
1	0	31023	31419	0.0102023	2.405412
1	0	32050	31966	0.0102023	3.271848
1	0	31246	31324	0.0102023	1.066778
1	0	31023	33200	0.0102023	2.078691
1	0	31419	32217	0.0102023	3.833369
2	1	31419	31255	0.0140662	1.683246
2	0	31071	31324	0.0140662	2.088897
2	0	32050	33200	0.0140662	2.527966
2	0	31313	32217	0.0140662	3.753660



```
rem(event ~ dist, data = sampled_dat, method = "clogit", stratum = "stratum")
```



Who first used this approach in REMs?



Social Networks

Volume 43, October 2015, Pages 121-135



Relational event models for social learning in MOOCs

Duy Vu ^a  , Philippa Pattison ^b  , Garry Robins ^a  



Network Science

Reliability of relational event model estimates under sampling: How to fit a relational event model to 360 million dyadic events

Published online by Cambridge University Press: 22 November 2019

Jürgen Lerner  and Alessandro Lomi

Show author details 

Article Metrics



Towards Case-control sampling via GLM

Full Likelihood via Poisson Regression... At what price?

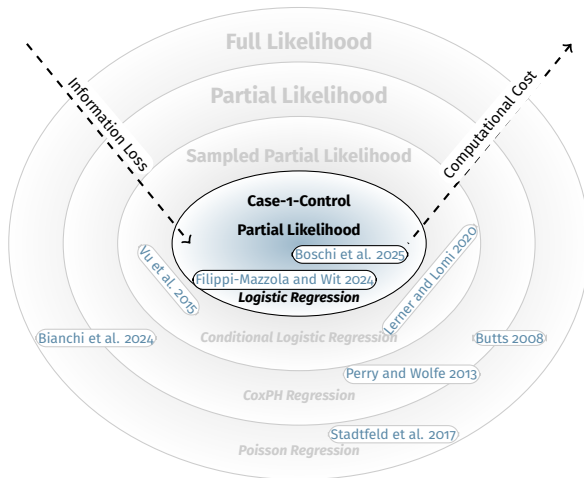
1. Strong Assumption;
2. High Computational Cost;

Well, we can do we even better!



Case-1-control Sampling Inference

Can we do more?





How to get a Logistic Regression... I

Sampled Partial likelihood with $m = 1$:

$$\mathcal{L}^S(\beta) \stackrel{m=1}{=} \prod_{i=1}^n \frac{\exp \{ \beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{s_i r_i}(t_i) \}}{\exp \{ \beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{s_i r_i}(t_i) \} + \exp \{ \beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{s_i^* r_i^*}(t_i) \}}$$



How to get a Logistic Regression... II

Sampled Partial likelihood with $m = 1$:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \mathcal{L}^S(\beta) &\stackrel{m=1}{=} \prod_{i=1}^n \frac{\exp\{\beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{s_i r_i}(t_i)\}}{\exp\{\beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{s_i r_i}(t_i)\} + \exp\{\beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{s_i^* r_i^*}(t_i)\}} \\
 &= \prod_{i=1}^n \frac{\frac{\exp\{\beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{s_i r_i}(t_i)\}}{\exp\{\beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{s_i^* r_i^*}(t_i)\}}}{\frac{\exp\{\beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{s_i r_i}(t_i)\}}{\exp\{\beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{s_i^* r_i^*}(t_i)\}} + \frac{\exp\{\beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{s_i^* r_i^*}(t_i)\}}{\exp\{\beta \cdot \mathbf{x}_{s_i^* r_i^*}(t_i)\}}} = \prod_{i=1}^n \frac{\exp\{\beta \cdot (\mathbf{x}_{s_i r_i}(t_i) - \mathbf{x}_{s_i^* r_i^*}(t_i))\}}{1 + \exp\{\beta \cdot (\mathbf{x}_{s_i r_i}(t_i) - \mathbf{x}_{s_i^* r_i^*}(t_i))\}} \\
 &= \prod_{i=1}^n \text{logistic}(\beta \cdot \Delta \mathbf{x}_i) \quad \Delta \mathbf{x}_i = \mathbf{x}_{s_i r_i}(t_i) - \mathbf{x}_{s_i^* r_i^*}(t_i)
 \end{aligned}$$

So, which statistical model should we focus on? (Pt. 4)

Sampled Partial likelihood with $m = 1$:

$$\mathcal{L}^S(\beta) \stackrel{m=1}{=} \prod_{i=1}^n \text{logistic}(\beta \cdot \Delta x_i) \quad \Delta x_i = x_{s_i r_i}(t_i) - x_{s_i^* r_i^*}(t_i)$$

Modeling:

Relational Event Model

$$\lambda_{sr}(t) = W_{sr}(t) \times \lambda_0(t) \times \exp \{ \beta \cdot x_{sr}(t) \}$$

Inference:

Logistic Regression

$$Y_i | \Delta x_i \stackrel{\text{iid}}{\sim} \text{Bernoulli}(\pi_i)$$

$$\text{logit}(\pi_i) = \beta \cdot \Delta x_i$$

$$y_i = 1 \quad i = 1, \dots, n; \quad \text{no intercept}$$

Wondering what advantage is? **Linearity** no more!

Case-1-control Sampling Inference via GLM in Practice I



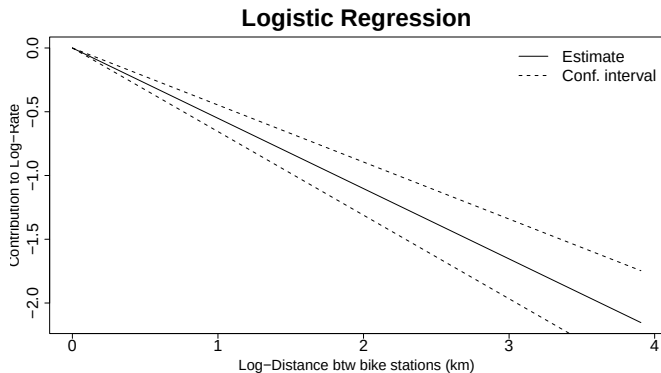
Sampled Partial likelihood with $m = 1$:

$$\mathcal{L}^S(\beta) \stackrel{m=1}{=} \prod_{i=1}^n \text{logistic}(\beta \cdot \Delta \mathbf{x}_i) \quad \Delta \mathbf{x}_i = \mathbf{x}_{s_i r_i}(t_i) - \mathbf{x}_{s_i^* r_i^*}(t_i)$$

stratum	time	sender_ev	receiver_ev	sender_nv	receiver_nv	dist_ev	dist_nv
1	0.0015464	31218	31255	31419	31419	1.6821306	0.0000000
2	0.0029034	31272	31324	33202	31966	1.7032925	2.873395
3	0.0096929	31937	32050	32050	31262	2.7475273	2.547647
4	0.0452324	31261	31262	31313	31218	1.1820339	2.201659
5	0.0517514	31272	31272	31419	31218	0.0000000	1.875181
6	0.0524939	33200	31261	31255	33202	0.5538851	1.243866
7	0.0531366	31285	31419	31419	33200	1.6052291	1.784903
8	0.0572758	32604	32217	31966	31262	3.0713035	2.821915
9	0.0628786	31285	33202	31071	31023	1.0922588	1.974220
10	0.0676353	31255	32050	31297	31272	2.4686079	1.655558



```
rem(~ dist, data = dat_gam, method = "gam")
```





Hands-on $\approx$ 20 minutes

- ▶ Simulate the data in R Studio.
- ▶ Construct the appropriate datasets for different inference approaches.
- ▶ Compare the obtained results.

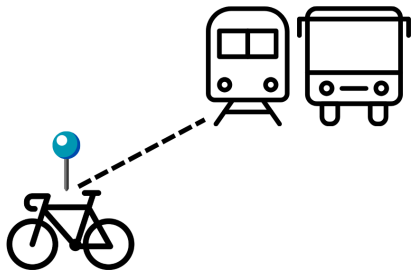
[https://martinaboschi.github.io/rem-tutorial/01-Introduction-to-REM/
01-Simulating-REM-Data/](https://martinaboschi.github.io/rem-tutorial/01-Introduction-to-REM/01-Simulating-REM-Data/)

All you need is linear, right?



LET'S TALK BIKE SHARING DYNAMICS

How does distance between a bike station and a public transportation hub affect the number of bike rides? Is this effect going to be the same at 8AM or 6PM compared to 2 PM?



We need **time-varying effects**: the risk factor x_{sr} has **different effect across time**

$$\beta(t) \cdot x_{sr}(t)$$

All you need is linear, right?



LET'S TALK BIKE SHARING DYNAMICS

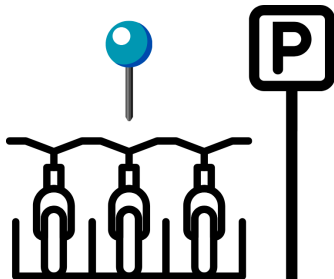
Do people bike far? What is the effect of biking 1km more if I have to bike 2kms compared to 20kms?

We need **non-linear effects**: **different effect for different values** assumed by the risk factor x_{sr}

$$f(x_{sr}(t))$$



All you need is linear, right?



LET'S TALK BIKE SHARING DYNAMICS

Not all bike stations are the same! Some have higher/lower usage due to aspects that are unrelated to the predictors we account for (e.g. bike availability, proximity to tourist attractions...).

We need **random effects**: accounts for the **heterogeneity** arising from the system features

$$\gamma \cdot v_{sr}(t)$$

Back to the hazard



$$\lambda_{sr}(t) = \underbrace{W_{sr}(t)}_{\text{risk indicator}} \times \underbrace{\lambda_0(t)}_{\text{baseline hazard}} \times \exp \left\{ \underbrace{f(x_{sr}(t), v_{sr}(t), t)}_{\text{contribution function}} \right\}$$

$$f(x_{sr}(t), v_{sr}(t), t) = \underbrace{\beta \cdot x_{sr}^{(1)}(t)}_{\text{fixed linear}} + \underbrace{\beta(t) \cdot x_{sr}^{(2)}(t)}_{\text{time-varying}} + \underbrace{f(x_{sr}^{(3)}(t))}_{\text{non-linear}} + \underbrace{\gamma \cdot v_{sr}(t)}_{\text{random}}$$

1. **fixed linear**: β is time-homogenous and is not a function of $x_{sr}^{(1)}(t)$;
2. **time-varying**: $\beta(t)$ is a non-linear function of time;
3. **non-linear**: $f(x_{sr}^{(3)}(t))$ is a non-linear function of $x_{sr}^{(3)}(t)$;
4. **random**: γ from a Gaussian random variable;



Modeling Time-Varying Effects

- ▶ Effect of $x_{sr}^{(2)}(t)$ as $\rightarrow$ **Spline function of Time**

$$\beta(t) \approx \sum_{j=1}^q \theta_j b_j(t)$$

Choices to be made:

- ▶ **basis dimension** q
- ▶ a **smooth basis functions** $\{b_j\}_j$ e.g. *B-splines, thin plate regression splines,...*
- ▶ given range of variable, **basis evaluation points** (e.g. *uniform, quantile of a distribution,...*) to evaluate q **smooth non-linear functions** of time $b_j(t)$.

Estimating $\beta(t) \iff$ Estimating θ_j -s

TVE: contribution of distance from public transport



► ... to log-hazard of an interaction

$$f(x_{sr}(t), v_{sr}(t), t) = \dots + \underbrace{\sum_{j=1}^q \theta_j b_j(t)}_{\text{time-varying effect}} \times \underbrace{x_{sr}^{(2)}(t)}_{\text{covariate}} + \dots$$

► ... to sampled partial likelihood (m=1)

$$\mathcal{L}^S(\beta) \stackrel{m=1}{=} \prod_{i=1}^n \frac{e^{\dots + \beta(t_i)[x_{s_i r_i}^{(2)}(t_i) - x_{s_i^* r_i^*}^{(2)}(t_i)] + \dots}}{1 + e^{\dots + \beta(t_i)[x_{s_i r_i}^{(2)}(t_i) - x_{s_i^* r_i^*}^{(2)}(t_i)] + \dots}}$$

$$\downarrow$$

$$\mathcal{L}^S(\theta) \stackrel{m=1}{=} \prod_{i=1}^n \frac{e^{\dots + [\sum_{j=1}^q \theta_j b_j(t_i)] \Delta x_i^{(2)} + \dots}}{1 + e^{\dots + [\sum_{j=1}^q \theta_j b_j(t_i)] \Delta x_i^{(2)} + \dots}} \quad (+ \text{ smoothing penalty})$$

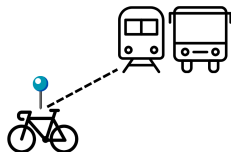
TVE: contribution of distance from public transport



► ... to sampled partial likelihood (m=1)

$$\mathcal{L}^S(\theta) \stackrel{m=1}{=} \prod_{i=1}^n \frac{e^{\dots + [\sum_{j=1}^q \theta_j b_j(t_i)] \Delta x_i^{(2)} + \dots}}{1 + e^{\dots + [\sum_{j=1}^q \theta_j b_j(t_i)] \Delta x_i^{(2)} + \dots}} \quad (+ \text{ smoothing penalty})$$

stratum	time	sender_ev	receiver_ev	sender_nv	receiver_nv	distPT_ev	distPT_nv
1	0.0014511	32217	32604	32604	31937	3.8203727	6.2539595
2	0.0015844	31937	31285	32217	31246	1.7116404	3.8203727
3	0.0081908	31324	31218	31272	31261	1.3001624	2.2255955
4	0.0117318	31313	31272	31297	32604	2.3462775	0.7931991
5	0.0145487	31285	32217	31261	31285	2.3303198	1.4511050
6	0.0183787	33200	31313	31262	31419	4.1927036	1.1147747
7	0.0199062	31218	31285	31966	31255	1.9189675	1.8293264
8	0.0203390	31023	31272	31023	31324	0.8268842	0.8268842
9	0.0211421	31966	31246	33202	31966	1.8293264	3.2714157
10	0.0224279	33200	32050	31297	31071	4.1927036	0.7931991

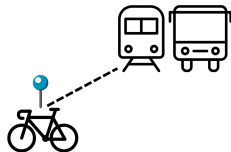
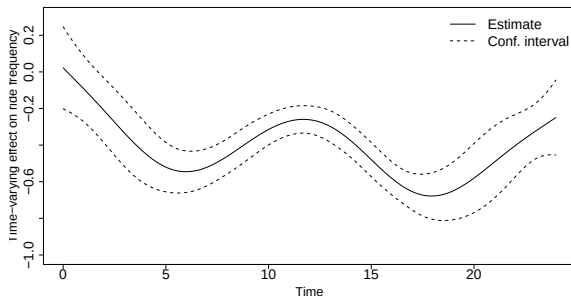


```
rem(~ tv(distPT), time = "time", data = dat_gam_tv, method = "gam")
```


TVE: contribution of distance from public transport

► ... to **sampled partial likelihood (m=1)**

$$\mathcal{L}^S(\theta) \stackrel{m=1}{=} \prod_{i=1}^n \frac{e^{\dots + [\sum_{j=1}^q \theta_j b_j(t_i)] \Delta x_i^{(2)} + \dots}}{1 + e^{\dots + [\sum_{j=1}^q \theta_j b_j(t_i)] \Delta x_i^{(2)} + \dots}} \quad (+ \text{smoothing penalty})$$



Modeling Non-Linear Effects



- ▶ Effect of $x_{sr}^{(3)}(t)$ as $\rightarrow$ **Spline function of Covariate**

$$f(x_{sr}^{(3)}(t)) \approx \sum_{j=1}^q \theta_j b_j(x_{sr}^{(3)}(t))$$

Choices to be made:

- ▶ **basis dimension** q
- ▶ a **set of smooth basis functions** $\{b_j\}_j$ e.g. *B-splines, thin plate regression splines,...*
- ▶ given range of variable, **basis evaluation points** (e.g. *uniform, quantile of a distribution,...*) to evaluate q **smooth non-linear functions** of covariate $b_j(x_{sr}^{(3)}(t))$.

Estimating $f \iff$ Estimating θ_j -s



NLE: contribution of distance btw two bike stations

- ... to **log-hazard of an interaction**

$$f(\mathbf{x}_{sr}(t), t) = \dots + \underbrace{\sum_{j=1}^q \theta_j b_j(x_{sr}^{(3)}(t))}_{\text{non-linear effect}} + \dots$$

- ... to **sampled likelihood function (m=1)**

$$\mathcal{L}^S(\boldsymbol{\theta}) \stackrel{m=1}{=} \prod_{i=1}^n \frac{e^{\dots + \left[\sum_{j=1}^q \theta_j [b_j(x_{s_i r_i}^{(3)}(t_i)) - b_j(x_{s_i^* r_i^*}^{(3)}(t_i))] \right] + \dots}}{1 + e^{\dots + \left[\sum_{j=1}^q \theta_j [b_j(x_{s_i r_i}^{(3)}(t_i)) - b_j(x_{s_i^* r_i^*}^{(3)}(t_i))] \right] + \dots}} \quad (+ \text{ smoothing penalty})$$



NLE: contribution of distance btw two bike stations

► ... to sampled likelihood function (m=1)

$$\mathcal{L}^S(\theta) \stackrel{m=1}{=} \prod_{i=1}^n \frac{e^{\dots + \left[\sum_{j=1}^q \theta_j [b_j(x_{s_i r_i}^{(3)}(t_i)) - b_j(x_{s_i^* r_i^*}^{(3)}(t_i))] \right] + \dots}}{1 + e^{\dots + \left[\sum_{j=1}^q \theta_j [b_j(x_{s_i r_i}^{(3)}(t_i)) - b_j(x_{s_i^* r_i^*}^{(3)}(t_i))] \right] + \dots}} \quad (+ \text{ smoothing penalty})$$

stratum	time	sender_ev	receiver_ev	sender_nv	receiver_nv	dist_ev	dist_nv
1	0.0013772	33202	32604	32604	31937	2.712905	2.328253
2	0.0014538	31937	31285	32217	31246	1.687139	3.801985
3	0.0019790	33200	31937	31255	31261	1.833861	1.058137
4	0.0044957	31246	31937	31218	31937	1.466260	1.946053
5	0.0074578	31324	31218	31272	31261	1.603420	1.458615
6	0.0105801	31272	31324	31272	31937	1.703293	2.039791
7	0.0112535	31966	31262	31285	32217	2.821915	3.821223
8	0.0113760	33202	32217	31272	31261	3.849168	1.458615
9	0.0117538	31313	31262	33202	32604	2.015569	2.712905
10	0.0142903	31246	33200	31966	31255	1.096610	2.766130



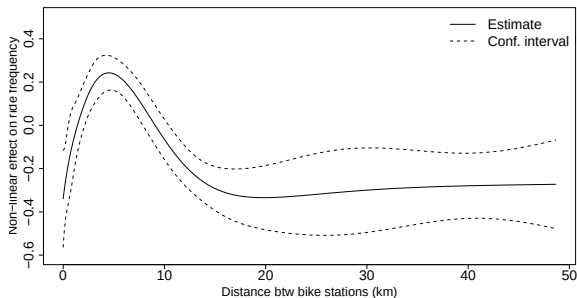
```
rem(~ nl(dist), data = dat_gam_nl, method = "gam")
```

NLE: contribution of distance btw two bike stations



► ... to **sampled likelihood function (m=1)**

$$\mathcal{L}^S(\theta) \stackrel{m=1}{=} \prod_{i=1}^n \frac{e^{\dots + \left[\sum_{j=1}^q \theta_j [b_j(x_{s_i r_i}^{(3)}(t_i)) - b_j(x_{s_i^* r_i^*}^{(3)}(t_i))] \right] + \dots}}{1 + e^{\dots + \left[\sum_{j=1}^q \theta_j [b_j(x_{s_i r_i}^{(3)}(t_i)) - b_j(x_{s_i^* r_i^*}^{(3)}(t_i))] \right] + \dots}} \quad (+ \text{ smoothing penalty})$$



Modeling Random Effects



- ▶ Effect of $v_{sr}(t) = \mathbb{1}\{\text{start station} = s\}$ as $\rightarrow$ **0 - dim spline**

$$\gamma \cdot v_{sr}(t) \approx \sum_{s' \in V} \gamma_{s'} \mathbb{1}\{s' = s\} \quad \gamma = (\gamma_1, \dots, \gamma_{|V|})$$

- ▶ Consider a model with Gaussian random effects, $\gamma \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2 I_{|V|})$;
- ▶ Same as fitting a ridge regression model (quadratic penalty term on γ)

Estimating $\gamma \iff$ Estimating $\gamma_{s'}$ -s (and σ^2)

RE: contribution of bike station's popularity as start

► ... to **log-hazard of an interaction**

$$f_{sr} = \dots + \underbrace{\sum_{s' \in V} \gamma_{s'} \mathbb{1}\{s = s'\}}_{\text{random effect}} + \dots$$

► ... to **sampled log-likelihood function (m=1)**

$$\ell^S(\gamma) = \log \mathcal{L}^S(\gamma) \stackrel{m=1}{=} \sum_{i=1}^n \log \left(\frac{e^{\dots + \gamma_{s_i} - \gamma_{s_i^*} + \dots}}{1 + e^{\dots + \gamma_{s_i} - \gamma_{s_i^*} + \dots}} \right) - \frac{1}{2\sigma_{\text{station}}^2} \gamma \cdot \gamma$$

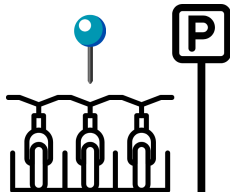
RE: contribution of bike station's popularity as start



► ... to sampled log-likelihood function (m=1)

$$\ell^S(\gamma) = \log \mathcal{L}^S(\gamma) \stackrel{m=1}{=} \sum_{i=1}^n \log \left(\frac{e^{\dots + \gamma_{s_i} - \gamma_{s_i^*} + \dots}}{1 + e^{\dots + \gamma_{s_i} - \gamma_{s_i^*} + \dots}} \right) - \frac{1}{2\sigma_{\text{station}}^2} \gamma \cdot \gamma$$

stratum	time	sender_ev	receiver_ev	sender_nv	receiver_nv
1	0.0013772	33202	32604	32604	31937
2	0.0014538	31937	31285	32217	31246
3	0.0019790	33200	31937	31255	31261
4	0.0044957	31246	31937	31218	31937
5	0.0074578	31324	31218	31272	31261
6	0.0105801	31272	31324	31272	31937
7	0.0112535	31966	31262	31285	32217
8	0.0113760	33202	32217	31272	31261
9	0.0117538	31313	31262	33202	32604
10	0.0142903	31246	33200	31966	31255

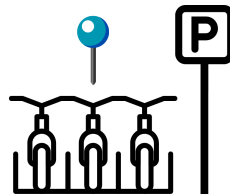
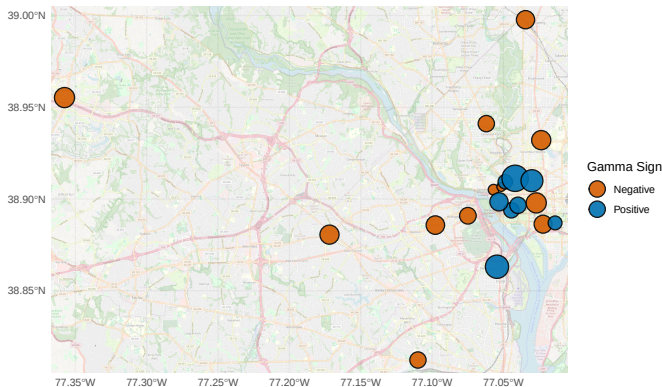


```
rem(~ re(sender), data = dat_gam_r, method = "gam")
```


RE: contribution of bike station's popularity as start

► ... to sampled log-likelihood function ($m=1$)

$$\ell^S(\gamma) = \log \mathcal{L}^S(\gamma) \stackrel{m=1}{=} \sum_{i=1}^n \log \left(\frac{e^{\dots + \gamma s_i - \gamma s_i^* + \dots}}{1 + e^{\dots + \gamma s_i - \gamma s_i^* + \dots}} \right) - \frac{1}{2\sigma_{\text{station}}^2} \gamma \cdot \gamma$$





Hands-on $\approx$ 35 minutes

- ▶ Load the data in R Studio.
- ▶ Create the case-control dataset and compute covariates.
- ▶ Fit models with linear, time-varying, non-linear, and random effects.

[https://martinaboschi.github.io/rem-tutorial/01-Introduction-to-REM/
02-Alien-Species-Invasions/](https://martinaboschi.github.io/rem-tutorial/01-Introduction-to-REM/02-Alien-Species-Invasions/)

Wrapping up



- ▶ (Some) Dynamic networks can be analyzed as temporal sequence of **relational events** between senders and receivers.
- ▶ REMs can capture complex temporal dynamics of interactions through:
 - both **exogenous** and **endogenous** covariates
 - flexible specification of effects (**non-linear, time-varying** and **random**, but more available...) easily estimated using efficient **logistic likelihood inference**.
- ▶ For more information on Relational Event Models, check out this tutorial paper (currently under review):



A tutorial paper on ‘amore’ will also be released soon..

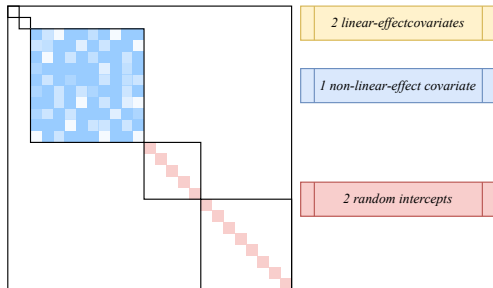
Smooth Relational Event Model



To avoid over-fitting, we consider a *penalized partial log-likelihood*;

$$\ell^\nu(\boldsymbol{\theta}) = \ell(\boldsymbol{\theta}) - P_\nu(\boldsymbol{\theta}) = \log(\mathcal{L}(\boldsymbol{\theta})) - \frac{1}{2} \sum_{l=1}^L \nu_l P_l, \quad P_l = \boldsymbol{\theta}_{j_l}^\top S_l \boldsymbol{\theta}_{j_l}, \quad j_l \subseteq \{1, \dots, |\boldsymbol{\theta}|\}$$

- ▶ **Linear:** $S_l = 0$;
 - ▶ **Time-Varying / Non-Linear:**
non-sparse S_l ;
 - ▶ **Random:**
 - **Penalized quasi-likelihood** for Gaussian random effects:
- $$\ell^\nu(\boldsymbol{\beta}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) \approx \ell(\boldsymbol{\beta}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) - \frac{1}{2} \boldsymbol{\theta}^\top \Sigma(\boldsymbol{\psi})^{-1} \boldsymbol{\theta}$$
- (Breslow and Clayton, 1993)
- S_l is an identity matrix;





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